



 EMUMBA

PROFESSIONAL PRACTICES IN IT

INTERVIEW REPORT

YEAR OF REPORT 2025

Professional Practices in IT Annual Semester Report 2025

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

Executive Summary

04

Introduction

05

Interviewee Introduction

06

Code of Ethics

07

Ethical Theories Followed

11

ACM/IEEE Code of Ethics

14

Handling Legal Aspects

17

Handling Intellectual Property Rights

21

Computer Crime Incidents

24

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Legal Contracts

27

Organizational Structure & Management

31

Software Business & Revenue Models

36

Additional Elements

39

Key Takeaways

42

Final Thoughts

44

Conclusion

45

Acknowledgement

46



Executive Summary



This report presents key insights into **professional practices** at **Emumba**, a leading **software services company** based in **Islamabad, Pakistan**. The findings are based on an in-depth interview with **Shehzad Saeed**, Engineering Manager, conducted on **22nd April 2025**.

Overview

Emumba combines **engineering excellence** with **client-focused innovation**, delivering **custom software solutions** across diverse industries. The interview explores Emumba's approach to **ethics, legal compliance, IP management**, and **organizational leadership**.

Though Emumba does not formally adopt **ACM/IEEE ethics codes**, its core values—**Respect, Responsibility, Freedom**, and **Accountability**—are embedded in daily practice. A notable example includes the ethical handling of a **religiously sensitive project**, where moral principles guided decisions over profit.

The company's recent **ISO 27001 certification** highlights its growing emphasis on **structured compliance** and **information security**. From a **startup culture** to a **collaborative enterprise**, Emumba focuses on **continuous learning, OKRs**, and embracing **emerging technologies** like Generative AI.

Emumba offers a compelling look at how modern IT firms can blend ethical integrity, legal diligence, and technological agility, all while cultivating a culture of innovation and collaboration.

Introduction

About Emumba

Founded in **2011**, **Emumba** is a globally recognized **software services company** delivering **high-quality, custom-engineered solutions**. The company is known for its blend of **engineering excellence** and **innovative thinking**, backed by strong partnerships with **Microsoft, Salesforce, and AWS**. Emumba's core areas include **Generative AI, cloud-native applications, data platforms, DevOps, test automation, and UI/UX design**. What sets Emumba apart is its **culture-driven approach**, grounded in **integrity, collaboration**, and a desire to make a **meaningful impact**.

Purpose of the Interview

The interview aimed to **bridge academic theory with practical insight**. One of our group members, **Maheen Mansha**, recommended Emumba as a prime organization for investigation. Our goal was to conduct a **meaningful interview** that would allow us to explore **how ethical theories, legal frameworks, and professional standards** taught in class are reflected in the **daily operations** of a thriving IT firm. This project aimed to both **validate our learning** and deepen our understanding of the **professional dynamics** shaping modern IT enterprises.



Why Emumba Was Chosen

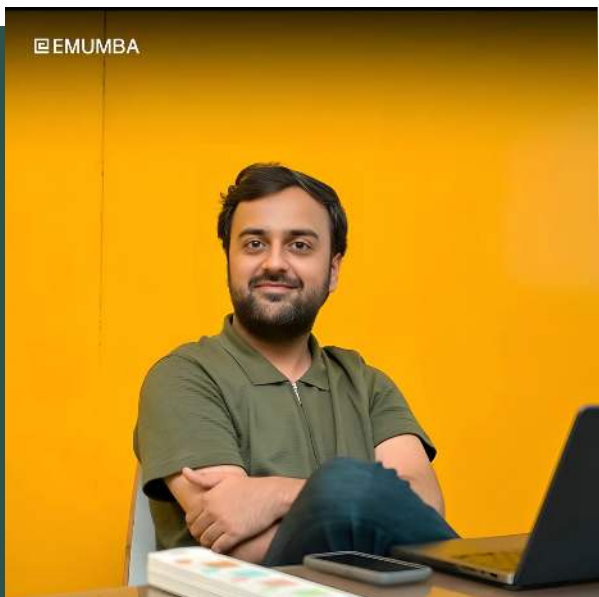
Emumba was selected for this project due to its **strong reputation** for being **culture-oriented** and its focus on **teamwork, responsibility, productivity, and quality**. Its widely praised **work environment** and emphasis on **professional ethics** made it an ideal case study to examine how **theoretical concepts** from our **Professional Practices in IT (PPIT)** course are applied in real corporate settings.



Interviewee Introduction

To begin our interview, we asked **Shehzad Saeed** to share a bit about himself and his journey at Emumba.

Shehzad currently holds the position of **Engineering Manager** at Emumba, where he has been a pivotal part of the organization for over **five years**. During this time, he has grown from managing a small team of just **four engineers** to now overseeing a **workforce of 60 to 70 professionals** within a company of approximately **500 employees**.



”

Reflecting on his career progression, Shehzad explained:

"When I joined, I was leading a very small team, but I knew if I wanted to grow, I had to step up. No one was going to hand me the opportunity—I had to take it."

His role primarily focuses on **organizational development**, ensuring that Emumba's engineering teams are not only efficient but also aligned with the company's broader goals. Over the years, he has taken on **critical responsibilities** such as **hiring, performance management, and team structuring**, all of which contribute to the strong leadership framework that Emumba thrives on today.

This introduction set the stage for a deeper dive into the company's **ethical foundations, management practices, and approach to professional conduct**, which unfolded in the subsequent sections of the interview.

“

Growth—both personal and for the company—only comes when someone takes the initiative," he added, emphasizing his belief in proactive leadership.

01. CODE OF ETHICS

Exploring the core values that shape professional conduct at Emumba.

“*Respect is a two-way street, if you want to get it, you've got to give it.*
– **R.G. Risch**



01. Code of Ethics

Building upon Shehzad Saeed's insights into leadership and growth at Emumba, we turned our focus towards understanding the ethical foundation that underpins the company's culture and professional environment.

Q: Describe Emumba's code of ethics.

While Emumba does not maintain a formal, consolidated document titled "**Code of Ethics**," the organization adheres to a deeply **ingrained set of values** that guide employee behavior and decision-making across all levels. These values are embedded in the company's **Cultural Book**, which acts as a practical guide for how individuals are expected to conduct themselves.

At the heart of Emumba's ethical philosophy is the principle of **Respect**. This value is not only encouraged but visibly promoted throughout the workplace. Shehzad shared:

“*Treating people with respect, irrespective of their seniority, gender, difference of opinion or status is an essential part of Emumba's culture. We have zero tolerance for any sort of disrespectful behavior.*”

This ethos is symbolized by a **Quranic verse displayed in the office**, reminding everyone that **dignity is universal**, whether someone is a **CEO or a junior employee**. Such a practice fosters a workplace defined by **inclusivity, dignity, and mutual regard**. Beyond respect, Emumba's culture is built on three foundational pillars:

Freedom “*Once told what to do, freedom is the ability to decide how to do it.*”

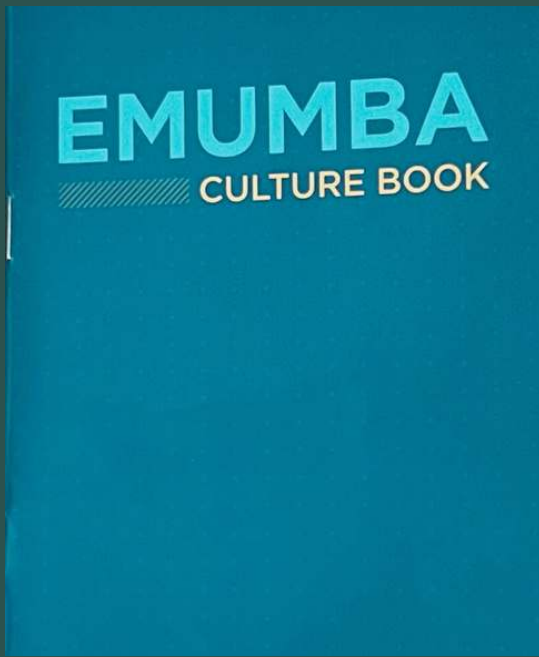
Employees are empowered to approach tasks creatively, provided they align with expected outcomes.

Responsibility Each team member is encouraged to **take ownership** of their work, proactively addressing challenges without waiting for instructions.

Accountability Freedom is **balanced with accountability**, ensuring that autonomy does not compromise quality or integrity.

Openness and **transparency** are essential to this ethical environment. Employees are **encouraged to admit mistakes**, even in client-facing situations, as honesty is seen as **vital to trust-building**.

Emumba's Cultural Book



While there is no formalized code in legal terms, the Cultural Book serves as Emumba's primary tool for communicating ethics. Described as taking just five minutes to read, this book is mandatory reading for every employee and distills the core values that define life at Emumba. Ethical behavior is communicated and reinforced through the three points listed on the right.

“*The quality of your work may only affect your project, but your behavior affects the company and Emumba's culture.*”

Q: Does your company have a documented code of ethics, or is it communicated to employees? How is it communicated?

01.

Visual reminders in the office, including religious and motivational quotes that uphold respect and integrity.

02.

Regular team discussions focused on **feedback**, **open communication**, and **conflict resolution**, all aimed at cultivating a collaborative and ethical work environment.

03.

Informal channels, such as **Slack**, where cultural values are discussed and ethical concerns can be raised and addressed.

As Shehzad explained, the belief at Emumba is simple:



Key Values Highlighted From the Cultural Book

وَلَقَدْ كَرَّمْنَا بَنِي آدَمَ

Verily, We have honoured the children of Adam...
The Holy Quran, 17:70

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21

Freedom, Responsibility, Accountability
The operational framework guiding work ethic.

Respect

The cornerstone of all interpersonal and professional interactions.

Conflict Resolution

Direct and amicable approaches to resolving disagreements.

Leadership & Learning

A focus on self-improvement as the path to effective leadership.

Communication & Feedback

Open, respectful exchanges for continuous improvement.

02. ETHICAL THEORIES FOLLOWED

How ethical decisions are guided by principles beyond policy.

“Do what is right, not what is easy.”



02. Ethical Theories Followed

Having understood Emumba's ethical values in theory, we sought to explore how these values come to life when the company faces **real-world ethical challenges**. Specifically, we wanted to know how **ethical decisions are made** and whether the company aligns with any **formal ethical frameworks**.

Q: How does the company handle ethical decision-making or conflicts of interest?

Shehzad explained that Emumba's approach to ethical decision-making is deeply rooted in **responsibility, integrity, and respect** for diverse cultural perspectives. While the company does not explicitly follow any one ethical theory, its actions often reflect key principles of both **Deontological Ethics**—doing what is right regardless of the outcome—and **Virtue Ethics**, which emphasizes moral character and integrity.

"There's no formal rulebook for every situation. What we do have is a shared understanding that we will act with honesty, even if it's difficult or costs us something."

When ethical dilemmas arise, Emumba encourages **open dialogue**, involving all relevant stakeholders to explore the issue thoroughly. The leadership is not hesitant to seek external guidance, especially in cases involving **cultural or religious nuances**, ensuring that decisions are aligned with not just professional standards but also **community values**.

Conflicts of interest are handled with **transparency**. Employees are expected to escalate concerns, and **senior management** takes an active role in ensuring that decisions uphold ethical conduct, even when they challenge **financial or operational priorities**.

Q: Can you share a situation where the company had to make an ethical choice?

To illustrate Emumba's commitment to ethical principles, Shehzad shared a **notable case** where the company faced a complex ethical decision, balancing business growth with **religious integrity**.

Traditionally focused on **US-based clients**, Emumba sought to **diversify** its portfolio by entering the **Middle Eastern market**, particularly the **UAE**. After **eight months** of effort, they secured a major project involving **future forecasting** and **dashboard development**, poised to be a **significant growth driver** for the company.

However, during the course of the project, a **concern was raised** by the project lead, who believed that aspects of the work might be **religiously inappropriate** under Islamic principles. What followed was a **rigorous ethical evaluation**:

- Emumba consulted with **multiple religious scholars (ulemas)** from various sects to seek clarity.
- After thorough discussions, a prominent scholar from **Karachi** concluded that the project was **not halal (permissible)**.
- This posed a **critical dilemma**: continue with a lucrative project, or stay true to their values?

"We had already invested time, effort, and resources. It wasn't an easy choice. But we knew what we had to do."

“

It wasn't just about stopping the work. It was about doing what's right, even when it costs you.

Emumba chose to **terminate the project**, forfeiting future collaboration with the client. Moreover, in a remarkable demonstration of integrity, all **profits earned** from the project were **donated to charity**.

Ethical Standpoint

This scenario illustrates how **conscience**, **core values**, and **cultural sensitivity** guide Emumba's business decisions. It reflects a company where **ethical conduct** is not bound by policy alone but is upheld through **principled leadership** willing to make the **hard, but right, choices**.

03. ACM/IEE CODE OF ETHICS

*Aligning global ethical standards with
daily practices.*

“*Integrity is doing the
right thing, even when
no one is watching.*
– C.S. Lewis



03. ACM/IEEE Code of Ethics at Emumba

As we delved deeper into Emumba's professional practices, we wanted to understand how global ethical standards, particularly those from the **ACM** and **IEEE**, influence their approach to software development and workplace behavior.



Q: Are the ACM/IEEE codes of ethics officially adopted or referenced in your organization?

While Emumba does not have a formal, documented adoption of the **ACM** or **IEEE Software Engineering codes of ethics**, their **day-to-day practices** and **ethical philosophy** closely mirror the principles these codes promote.

At Emumba, employees are seen not just as representatives of the company, but as ambassadors of **Pakistan**—a perspective that underscores the **responsibility** they carry, especially when working in **international environments**. Shehzad shared:

“ *We believe that being honest & fair isn't just about work—it's about who we are, especially when we're representing ourselves on a global stage.*

Core principles such as:

- Contributing to society and human well-being.
- Avoiding harm to others.
- Being honest and trustworthy.
- Respecting intellectual and creative efforts.

are deeply embedded in how employees are expected to conduct themselves, even if not explicitly labeled under the ACM or IEEE banner.

Q: If codes are being followed, how do they help you in the software development process?

Shehzad highlighted that ethics at Emumba are more than formal codes—they are a **foundation for resilience** in challenging, often **competitive environments**.

While **technical challenges** in software development are a given, Shehzad noted that the **greater challenge** often comes from **interpersonal dynamics**, particularly when engaging with **international clients** where **cultural biases** may arise.

- Employees are consistently encouraged to uphold **ethical consistency**, even when faced with **unfair treatment** or **targeted criticism**.
- Leadership reinforces the belief that **quality work** and **ethical conduct** will eventually **win recognition** and **trust**, regardless of initial resistance.

“

You don't just write good code. You need to show that you can rise above unfairness with integrity. That's what makes people respect you.

Real-World Application

When facing **racism** or **discrimination**—particularly noted in some collaborations with professionals from **competing markets**—Emumba staff are guided to **maintain professionalism**, avoid retaliation, and let their **work speak for itself**.

Shehzad remarked that while **bias** might be present initially, **consistent ethical behavior** leads to **acceptance** and **respect** over time.

Maintaining Values Across Team Sizes

In **smaller teams**, ethical guidance is easier to communicate directly from leadership. As teams grow, while there is a risk of **value dilution**, Emumba ensures that its **core values**—aligned with global standards—remain **strong** and **defining**.

Cultural reinforcement through regular dialogue and leadership practices sustains these values, ensuring that growth does not compromise ethics.

Ethical Insight

Emumba may not formally adopt ACM/IEEE codes, but the **spirit** of these frameworks is deeply **interwoven into their culture**. Their commitment to **honesty, responsibility, and fairness** is not just a guideline—it's a **way of working**, crucial in both **technical execution** and **global collaboration**.

04. HANDLING LEGAL ASPECTS

Managing compliance, contracts, and legal obligations in a global tech environment.

“*Laws control the lesser man... Right conduct controls the greater one.*
– **Mark Twain**



04. Handling Legal Aspects at Emumba

As our discussion transitioned into the regulatory and legal framework of Emumba, we sought to understand how a fast-growing software services company navigates the **complexities of compliance**, particularly as it expands into global markets.

Q: How does Emumba handle legal aspects and industry regulations?

Initially, Emumba's focus on **US and Southeast Asian markets** meant that **legal compliance** was not an immediate concern, primarily due to the **nature of client-driven projects**. However, with the growing emphasis on **global standards** in the tech industry, the company has significantly enhanced its compliance efforts.

Over the past year, Emumba prioritized formalizing its approach to **compliance**, culminating in a key achievement:

On the very day of our interview, Emumba had officially become **ISO 27001 certified**, signaling its commitment to **information security (IS) management** and aligning with international best practices.

Even before formal certification, Emumba had already embedded many **secure coding practices** and **internal controls**, which made the certification process more of a **formal recognition** than a fundamental shift.

“We were already following many of the things ISO asks for. The certification just confirmed what we had been doing all along,” Shehzad noted.

Q: How do you ensure legal compliance?

Emumba ensures compliance through a combination of contractual safeguards and structured internal processes:

01. Client Contracts

- **Non-Disclosure Agreements (NDAs)** protect intellectual property and sensitive client data.
- **Non-compete clauses** prevent clients from directly hiring Emumba's staff.

02. Employee Contracts

- These include clear clauses on **legal compliance, professional behavior, and moral responsibility.**

Internally, Emumba has developed control systems supported by external audit and legal advisors:

- **Annual audits** are submitted to Pakistan's **Federal Board of Revenue (FBR)**, though the review process remains a **bureaucratic formality.**
- Detailed records of **all financial and operational activities**, including minor expenses, are maintained for transparency and compliance.

Q: Were there any notable compliance challenges? If yes, how were they addressed?

Like many growing companies, Emumba has encountered its share of compliance challenges:

1. Tax Notices from FBR: Each year, Emumba receives standard notices from the FBR alleging underpayment. These are typically **procedural** in nature and are actively contested by Emumba's **legal team.**

2. Managing Scale: With over **400 employees**, managing the **paper trail** of receipts and expenses is a logistical challenge.

3. Client-Employee Conflicts: Despite contractual clauses, clients sometimes **attempt to hire Emumba employees directly.** While enforcement is difficult, Emumba relies on **professional ethics** and **industry reputation** to discourage such behavior.

“

Sometimes it feels like you're guilty until proven innocent. But we follow the process, submit our audits, and move on,” **Shehzad commented.**



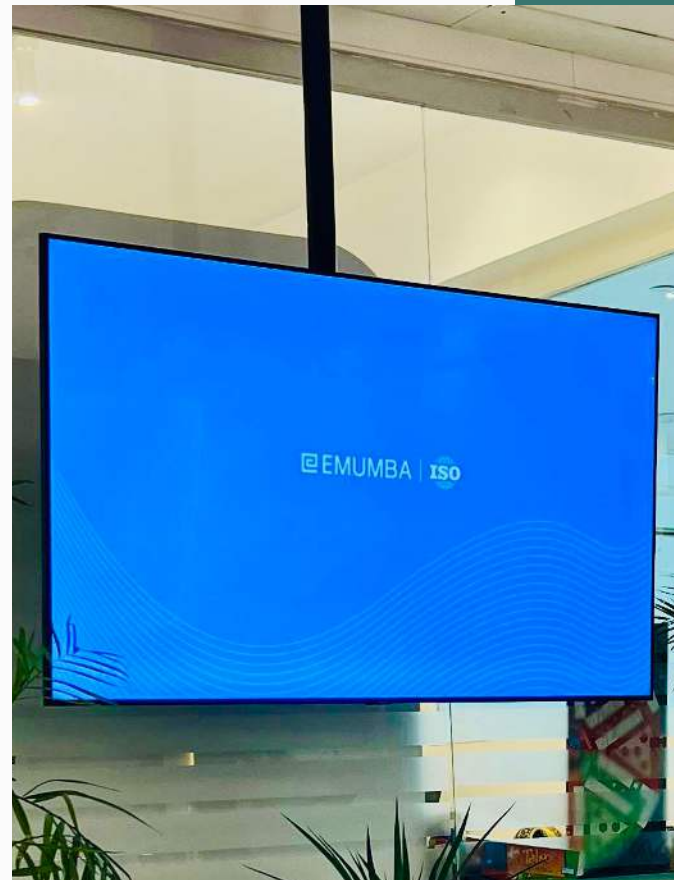
Q: Is there a dedicated legal team or legal advisor for Emumba?

Yes, Emumba maintains a **dedicated internal legal team** that:

- Manages routine **legal matters, contract drafting, and compliance enforcement.**
- Collaborates with **external legal agencies** to navigate more complex issues and to **identify legal loopholes** in both **local and international regulations.**

Legal Team's Scope

- **Tax compliance and dispute resolution.**
- **Contractual enforcement** for both clients and employees.
- **Regulatory audits** and ensuring **corporate structuring** complies with business laws.
- Addressing matters related to **employee relations** and **intellectual property.**



Compliance Perspective

Emumba's journey from an **informal approach** to achieving **ISO 27001 certification** marks a significant evolution in how it views legal compliance. By integrating **contractual rigor, internal controls,** and strategic **legal partnerships,** Emumba ensures it can effectively **mitigate risks** and meet the demands of both **domestic** and **international** clients.

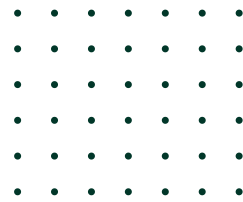
05. HANDLING IP RIGHTS

*Protecting client assets through trust,
contracts, and confidentiality.*

“*Intellectual property is
the oil of the 21st
century.*
– **Mark Getty**



05. Handling Intellectual Property (IP) Rights at Emumba



Understanding how intellectual property is managed is critical in a company that specializes in **custom software development**. We explored how Emumba approaches IP protection, especially given its **client-first service model**.

Q: How does Emumba protect intellectual property rights?

Shehzad explained that at Emumba, **intellectual property (IP) rights** are overwhelmingly **client-owned**. As a software services provider, the company's role is to **build solutions** for clients, while the **ownership** of those solutions—code, design, and related assets—**remains with the client**.

- **Client-Centric IP Ownership:** Emumba's projects are typically **custom-built**, and clients retain **full rights** to all deliverables.
- **Employee Awareness:** Employees and contractors are explicitly made aware that any IP created during a project is **client property**.
- **Tools and Platforms:** Apart from Emumba-provided **laptops**, most tools and resources used are **client-specified**, reinforcing their control over the work environment and IP.

Safeguarding Rights

- **Non-Disclosure Agreements (NDAs)** and **IP clauses** are standard in all contracts.
- Employees are **contractually bound** to maintain **confidentiality** and to avoid using any client-owned IP **outside** the scope of the project.

99%

Right to Product

"Almost 99% of the time, the product isn't ours—it belongs to the client. We're here to build it, not to own it."

Q: Have there been any issues with intellectual property violations?

When asked about IP violations, Shehzad confidently noted:

“We haven’t had any major issues. Clients know we take their IP seriously, and our team respects that boundary.”

01.

No Major Violations:

Emumba has a **clean record** concerning IP disputes or violations.

02.

Clients themselves are responsible for defining **how their IP is protected**, including **copyrights, trademarks, or patents**.

03.

Emumba supports this by ensuring **strict compliance** with client-specific IP guidelines, and by maintaining a **high level of professional integrity** within its workforce.

CEO DVSum

Aashish Singhvi



This project was high complexity and the Emumba team demonstrated excellent qualities throughout. No corners were cut and a diligent and thorough QA was done to ensure (that) the produced solution was of high quality. Two 🙌🙌 and highly recommended.

Ownership Perspective

Emumba’s **client-first approach** to intellectual property ensures clarity and respect in every engagement.

Through **robust contracts** and a **disciplined work culture**, Emumba effectively supports IP protection, building **trust and reliability** with clients worldwide.

06. COMPUTER CRIME INCIDENTS

Securing systems and information in a rapidly evolving digital landscape.

“*Security is not a product,
but a process.*
– **Bruce Schneier**



06. Incidents of Computer Crimes at Emumba

With increasing digital threats in today's interconnected world, we explored how Emumba protects itself against **computer crimes** and manages **information security**, especially in light of its recent compliance milestones.

Q: Are there any measures implemented to prevent or respond to computer crimes?

Emumba has taken **significant steps** in recent years to bolster its **defenses** against potential computer crimes, largely driven by their pursuit and achievement of **ISO 27001 certification**—a globally recognized standard for **information security management**.

Key Initiatives

Centralized Tool & Asset Management

In the past, there was no **formal tracking** of tools or resources, allowing employees **independent access** for actions like issuing IPs or managing hardware. Over the last **two years**, Emumba centralized these processes, now efficiently managing **50-60 tools** across the company.

No Dedicated Cybersecurity Team

Emumba's **IT department** currently handles **security-related tasks**, maintaining basic safeguards and **ensuring compliance** with internal standards.

Structured IT and Network Departments

The company has reorganized its **IP, administration, and network teams** into a **dedicated structure** focusing on **IT asset management** and **security functions**. Emphasis has been placed on **responsible usage** of company resources.

ISO 27001 Controls

These controls provide a **structured framework** for staying **vigilant** and **proactive** against cyber threats.

Despite improvements, some **practices remain flexible**—such as the use of **company laptops** similarly to personal devices—indicating a **need for ongoing monitoring** to reinforce **endpoint security**.



INFOSEC 27001

Launching the Internal Audit

Q: Has your company faced any cyberattacks? If yes, how was it addressed?

No **major cyberattacks** were reported during the interview. However, Shehzad noted that recent infrastructure and compliance upgrades have made the organization **more resilient**.

“We’ve moved from a time where there was little control, to now, where we know exactly what’s being used and how. That alone makes us stronger.”

- Emumba’s shift from an **unstructured IT** model to a **policy-driven security environment** is evident, with **ISO 27001 certification** acting as both a **benchmark** and a **motivator** for continued vigilance.
- These developments have **reduced risk exposure** significantly and reflect a **proactive approach** to securing organizational assets.

Security Perspective

Emumba’s evolution from **ad-hoc IT practices** to **centralized, compliance-based security management** marks a significant leap in their ability to prevent computer crimes. While a **dedicated cybersecurity team** is yet to be established, the current IT-led framework, underpinned by **ISO 27001 standards**, ensures that **security remains a priority** as the company grows.

06. LEGAL CONTRACTS

*The foundation of trust and clarity in
client and employee relations.*

“

*A verbal contract isn't
worth the paper it's
written on.*

– Samuel Goldwyn



07. Contracts at Emumba

Contracts form the foundation of **professional relationships** at Emumba, not only defining **responsibilities** but also protecting the **interests** of the company, its employees, and its clients. We explored how Emumba structures these agreements and manages violations when they occur.

“Our contracts start open-ended because our clients often don’t know exactly what they need. It’s our job to help shape that along the way.”

01. Non-Disclosure Agreements (NDAs)

Every employee signs an NDA to ensure **client confidentiality** and the protection of **sensitive information**

02. Statements of Work (SoWs)

- SoWs are **project-specific agreements** that define the **scope, deliverables, and timelines** for each client engagement.
- Often, these start as **broad or vague**, especially since many clients approach Emumba with **only a general vision**.
- As projects develop—sometimes over 1-2 years—the **scope becomes more defined**, reflecting an evolving understanding of client needs.

Q: What kind of contracts are signed between employees and the company?

Emumba operates with a **clear contractual framework** tailored to safeguard both **internal and client engagements**. The key contracts include:

Q: If an employee violates a specific contract clause, how does Emumba deal with it?

Emumba adopts a **pragmatic approach** when handling **contract violations**, particularly in scenarios involving **employee poaching** or **non-compete breaches**.

CASE Example

A year ago, a client attempted to **hire an Emumba employee directly**, breaching contractual terms.

Although Emumba sought to enforce the contract, the employee had already accepted the offer. Emumba responded by **terminating the client contract**, choosing **not to pursue legal action** against the employee.

Industry Practice

Emumba leans on **professional reputation** within the **tight-knit Pakistani tech industry**.

Details about breaches are often **informally shared**, potentially affecting the future employability of those involved.

Interestingly, **many employees return** after realizing the **value** of Emumba's work culture.

Legal Stance

For serious infractions like **theft of IP**, legal recourse is considered.

For **standard breaches** (e.g., early resignation), Emumba typically **avoids legal action**, recognizing its **limited effectiveness** and instead focusing on **internal discipline** and **industry norms**.



“Chasing legal battles over every breach isn’t worth it. We prefer to move on and focus on what we can control.”

Q: How are supplier and client contracts managed?



Client Contracts

Governed primarily by **Statements of Work (SoWs)**. These outline the **nature of work, deliverables, and payment terms**.

Due to Emumba's **innovation-driven approach**, initial requirements are often **unclear** and evolve significantly as projects progress

Supplier Contracts

Managed through **standard agreements**, though these were not a major focus during the interview.

Practical Approach

Emumba balances **legal structure** with **real-world flexibility**, using contracts to define expectations but relying on **reputation** and **industry standards** for enforcement. Legal action is reserved for **serious violations**, while **most issues** are resolved through **professional integrity** and a **focus on long-term relationships**.

08. ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

Leadership, collaboration, and decision-making at every level.

“ *The strength of the team is each individual member. The strength of each member is the team.*
– **Phil Jackson**



08. Organizational Structure & Management at Emumba

As we explored Emumba's ethical and legal practices, it became essential to understand the **organizational structure** that supports such a dynamic environment. From leadership to culture, Emumba's internal framework plays a key role in fostering **ethical conduct**, **collaborative growth**, and **effective decision-making**.

Q: Can you describe Emumba's organizational structure?

Emumba's organizational structure has evolved significantly to support its expanding team and technological focus. Starting in **2019**, when the company reached approximately **80 employees**, distinct **vertical departments** were introduced to streamline operations.



Owais Anjum
CEO



Zishan Iqbal
CTO



Fahad Munawar Jan
VP Engineering



Dr. Affan Syed
Senior Director of Tech



Muhammad Wasaaq
Director Engineering

“Our structure isn’t just about roles. It’s about making sure every voice matters, from juniors to leadership.”

Hierarchy Overview

1. **CEO** – Oversees strategic direction and leadership.
2. **CTO, Senior Directors, Vice President** – Drive innovation and manage cross-departmental leadership.
3. **Department Managers** – Lead technical domains like Frontend, Backend, and DevOps.
4. **Senior Engineers/Managers** – Provide mentorship and oversee project leadership.
5. **Junior Engineers/Mentees** – Focus on execution and growth under senior guidance.

Major Departments

1. Backend Development
2. Frontend Development
3. Quality Assurance (QA)
4. UI/UX Design
5. DevOps
6. Project Management
7. AWS/Generative AI Solutions

This **tiered structure** allows for **efficient communication**, **clear accountability**, and a balance between **autonomy** and **oversight**.

Q: How are ethical decisions escalated or handled?

Ethical concerns at Emumba are managed through a **collaborative leadership approach**, ensuring inclusivity and transparency.

Decision Forums

- **Quarterly Offsite Meetings:** Full-day strategic and ethical reviews (often at venues like Serena Hotel).
- **Slack Channels:** Open forums for employees to raise concerns and receive real-time feedback.
- **Ad Hoc Teams:** Formed for issue-specific resolution, including ethical matters.

Leadership Group

Includes **Team Leads, Directors,** and **Senior Engineers** (~18 members).
Addresses **operational** and **ethical issues** regularly.

Executive Group

Comprises the **CEO, CTO, VP,** and **Senior Directors.**
Handles **high-level ethical decisions** and company strategy.

Q: How is decision-making done hierarchy-wise?

Decision-making at Emumba is both **structured** and **inclusive**:

Team-level Decisions

Handled at the **project/task level**, with clear escalation paths for **complex issues**.

Strategic Decisions

Led by the **CEO** and **CTO**, with senior leadership collaboration.

Departmental Decisions

Managed by **Department Managers**, incorporating **Senior Engineer** input.

Feedback

FB from **junior staff** is **valued**, creating a **bottom-up influence** on organizational direction.

“We rarely have to escalate beyond the leadership group. Trust is key, and people know their concerns will be heard.”

Q: What values drive Emumba's culture?

Emumba's culture is shaped by core values that permeate both **daily work** and **long-term strategies**:

Freedom

Empowering employees to decide **how** they achieve results.

Responsibility

Fostering **ownership** and **self-discipline**.

Accountability

Balancing autonomy with **ethical accountability**.

Respect

Ensuring dignity for all, as reinforced in the **Cultural Book**.

Collaboration

Promoting **team-driven** solutions and **collective success**.



Leadership Perspective

Emumba's structure champions **collaborative leadership** and **ethical integrity**, balancing formal hierarchies with **open participation**. This flexible yet **accountable governance model** ensures that the company grows while maintaining its commitment to **values**, **transparency**, and **employee empowerment**.

09. REVENUE MODELS

Delivering value through custom software services and client partnerships.

“Revenue is vanity, profit is sanity, but cash is king.”





09. Software Business and Revenue Models at Emumba

To understand how Emumba sustains its operations and growth, we explored the company's **revenue generation model** and how it differentiates itself in the **software services industry**.

Q: What is your primary revenue model?

Emumba's primary focus lies in **custom software services**, where they partner with clients to **design, develop, and maintain** bespoke software solutions. Unlike product-based companies, Emumba does not sell its own proprietary software but instead provides **end-to-end development services** tailored to the specific needs of each client.

Primary Revenue Source

Revenue is generated through **software services**, not through direct product sales.

Billing is based on:

- Project scope, defined in a **Statement of Work (SoW)**.
- **Resource allocation**, depending on the **size and expertise** of the team deployed.
- **Project complexity** and **duration**.

“ Our business isn't about creating one product and selling it to many. It's about creating many unique solutions, each crafted for a specific client.



Q: What business/revenue models does Emumba use?

Emumba's model is firmly service-based, distinguishing it from traditional product companies.

Client Engagement

- Emumba serves **15-16 active clients**, with projects ranging from **small teams of 4 to large-scale projects** involving **70+ team members**.
- Projects vary in **scope and scale**, driven by client requirements, industry dynamics, and technical complexity.

Types of Software Companies

- **Product-Based:** Companies that build and sell software products (e.g., SaaS platforms).
- **Service-Based:** Companies like Emumba that deliver **customized development services**.

Even though Emumba's business involves **creating products**, the ownership always lies with the **client**. Their role is to ensure **quality delivery**, while the **revenue** is generated from **service engagements**, not product licensing or sales.

Revenue Perspective

Emumba's success lies in its ability to deliver **highly customized software services**, offering **scalable solutions** that cater to both **startups** and **large enterprises**. This **flexible, client-driven model** allows Emumba to maintain strong relationships and sustain growth without relying on proprietary product sales.

10. ADDITIONAL ELEMENTS

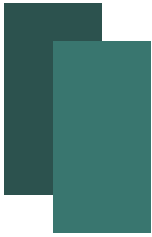
Driving innovation through continuous learning and trend adaptation.

“ *Innovation distinguishes between a leader and a follower.*
– **Steve Jobs**





10. Additional Elements in Emumba's Professional Practices



To conclude our exploration, we looked at how Emumba maintains its **technological edge** and fosters **unique professional practices** that contribute to its **adaptive** and **innovative culture**.

Q: How does Emumba handle emerging trends and technology in such a competitive environment?

Emumba takes a **proactive stance** in keeping pace with **emerging technologies**, especially in **cutting-edge domains** such as **Generative AI (GenAI)**, **cloud computing**, and **DevOps**.

As trends evolve, Emumba recognizes the **imperative to adapt**. Employees are encouraged –and often required–to **learn and master** new tools and methodologies to **stay competitive**.

An internal tool, "**Genee**", was developed to **analyze project structures** and promote **efficiency and innovation** from project inception.

With the surge in **GenAI**, Emumba has:

- Experienced a **shift in workload dynamics**, as specialized tools require **fewer but more skilled** personnel.
 - Formed **dedicated trend-monitoring teams**, responsible for **researching** emerging technologies and **communicating insights** throughout the organization.
 - Strategically integrated these insights into **client projects**, ensuring solutions are both **current** and **innovative**.
- 

“We don’t just wait for trends to become mainstream—we explore, test, and adapt early.”

Q: Are there any unique aspects in professional practices in IT that Emumba considers important?

Several unique practices shape Emumba's **distinct professional environment**, enhancing both **performance** and **employee growth**.

OKRs (Objectives & Key Results)

Borrowed from **Google's startup model**, OKRs align goals at **individual, departmental, and company-wide** levels.

This framework:

- Encourages **goal-setting** and **clear progress tracking**.
- Ensures focus on **learning, project delivery, and innovation**.
- Fosters an environment of **continuous personal development**.

Each department sets **annual OKRs**, followed by evaluations on **achievements** and **learning growth**.

Continuous Learning Focus

Emumba fosters a **habitual learning culture**, especially in **emerging technologies**.

Regular engagement with domains like **GenAI** ensures the workforce remains **technologically relevant** and **skilled**.

Innovation-Driven Culture

Emumba's tagline, "***Innovation of Enterprises***," reflects its **commitment to creativity**.

Clients often come with **undefined needs**, relying on Emumba to **co-create solutions** through **iterative development** and **collaborative design**.

Innovation Perspective

Emumba thrives on **agility and innovation**, blending **trend awareness, structured goal-setting, and continuous learning**. Their commitment to **cutting-edge technology** and **enterprise-level thinking** positions them as a leader in delivering **future-ready solutions**, while cultivating a **culture of growth** and **accountability**.

“It's not just about delivering what clients ask—it's about helping them discover what they truly need.”

Key Takeaways

The interview with **Shehzad Saeed**, Engineering Manager at **Emumba**, provided a rich understanding of how **ethical leadership**, **technological innovation**, and **structured professionalism** intersect to define the company's success. The following key takeaways highlight the essence of Emumba's professional practices:

1. Ethics as a Practiced Culture, Not Just Policy

Emumba doesn't rely on a formal code of ethics but instead embeds **Respect, Freedom, Responsibility**, and **Accountability** into daily operations.

Ethical dilemmas, including religious sensitivities, are approached with integrity, reflecting **Deontological** and **Virtue Ethics** in action.

2. Global Standards, Local Adaptation

Recently achieving **ISO 27001 certification**, Emumba has elevated its legal and security compliance, ensuring both **internal control** and **client trust**.

Legal frameworks are enforced through **contracts**, while **industry reputation** plays a key role in handling breaches pragmatically.

3. Services over Products: A Scalable Business Model

Emumba thrives as a **software services company**, with a **custom development focus** supporting diverse clients through **tailored engagements**.

Revenue is generated not from selling products, but from **designing and building them for others**.

Key Takeaways

4. Client-First Intellectual Property Approach

Emumba's **service model** ensures that all developed products are **client-owned**, and robust **NDA enforcement** safeguards IP integrity.

5. Evolution from Flexibility to Structured Security

Formerly unstructured, Emumba now operates under **centralized IT management**, reducing the risks of **computer crimes** and increasing **cyber vigilance**.

6. Leadership-Driven, Inclusive Management

Ethical concerns are handled via **collaborative leadership forums**, from **quarterly off-site meetings** to real-time **Slack discussions**. The **organizational structure** ensures that **decision-making** flows both top-down and bottom-up, valuing **input at all levels**.

7. Commitment to Innovation and Continuous Learning

Through initiatives like **OKRs** and dedicated **trend-monitoring teams**, Emumba stays at the forefront of **emerging technologies** such as **Generative AI**. Tools like **Genee** and a focus on **habitual learning** help maintain a **dynamic** and **future-ready workforce**.

Final Thoughts

“

Emumba exemplifies a company that has grown by **staying true to its values, adapting to global demands, and innovating alongside its clients.** Their journey from a **flexible startup** to a **structured leader** in the software services industry highlights the power of **ethical integrity, collaborative management, and technological foresight.**

Conclusion

Conducting this interview with **Shehzad Saeed** at **Emumba** was an invaluable experience that offered a **practical lens** into the world of **professional practices in IT**. It provided us with a unique opportunity to engage with real-world applications of the **ethical theories, legal considerations, and organizational principles** we have studied throughout our course. What stood out was how seamlessly Emumba integrates **culture, compliance, and innovation**, creating a workplace that not only thrives on technical excellence but also on **integrity and collaboration**.

This experience significantly **enhanced our understanding** of how IT companies function beyond theoretical models. Seeing concepts like **Deontological Ethics, IP management, ISO certification, and organizational leadership** applied in a real setting helped us appreciate the **complexities and nuances** involved in professional environments. It highlighted that ethics and legal frameworks are not just abstract ideas but are actively shaping decisions and strategies in **dynamic, high-stakes scenarios**.

On a personal and academic level, we gained deep insights into the **value of continuous learning**, the **importance of adaptive leadership**, and how a **values-driven culture** can be a foundation for **sustainable success**. Emumba's **client-first mindset**, combined with their commitment to **technological agility** and **ethical responsibility**, serves as a compelling model for aspiring professionals like us.

This project has not only reinforced the relevance of our course material but also inspired us to approach our future careers with a strong emphasis on ethical integrity, responsibility, & a collaborative spirit.





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